The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY · KEY NUMBERS · FROM THE INBOX · ON X · CYCLE TRACKER · EVENTS

KOREA TUESDAY — CLOSE
KOSPI 5,239.13 +4.39%; Samsung ₩198,900 +4.74% · SK hynix ₩1,212,000 +6.69% · KRX via Naver

MICRON (MON CLOSE) · DRAM SPOT TUESDAY
$733.15 +6.25%; DDR5 16Gb $60.167 (0.00%); DDR4 16Gb $79.99 (−0.31%) · TrendForce Nov 10 11:00 GMT+8

LEAD STORY

KOREA · US MONDAY · TRENDFORCE

Memory Stocks Snap Back as TrendForce Sees a 2027 Server-DRAM Gap

The SOX gained 6.85% on Monday and Micron 6.25%; in Seoul SK hynix closed +6.69% as foreigners bought for the first time in eight sessions. TrendForce says 2027 server DRAM supply grows about 25%, slower than server CPU demand, though DRAM lead times eased a week to 18. Spot edged lower again.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:40 IST Tuesday (UTC+2) · Korea = final close · US = Monday close · Spot TrendForce Nov 10 11:00 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · KOREA TUESDAY CLOSE · US MONDAY CLOSE · SPOT TUESDAY

KOREA, TUESDAY CLOSE

KOSPI	**5,239.13 (+4.39%)**
Samsung	**₩198,900 (+4.74%)**
SK hynix	**₩1,212,000 (+6.69%)**
KOSPI Mon final (revised)	**5,018.85 (−0.81%)**
TSMC Oct revenue	**NT$586.9bn (+59.7% y/y)**

US MONDAY CLOSES AND SPOT

Micron	**$733.15 (+6.25%)**
Sandisk	**$886.51 (+6.16%)**
SOX	**10,033.93 (+6.85%)**
Nvidia	**$178.67 (−4.27%)**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.17 (0.00%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$79.99 (−0.31%)**

What this shows: the equity rebound was broad (SK hynix ADR +5.53%, Applied Materials +11.37%), but Nvidia fell on its CEO probe. DRAM spot did not join the rally: DDR5 flat, DDR4 down a fourth session. NAND wafer spot ($16.15, −4.33% w/w) is carried from the last weekly print. Monday's KOSPI final (5,018.85) revises No. 34's preliminary 5,019.78. Sources: KRX via Naver Finance, Yonhap, Yahoo Finance, FnNews, TSMC, TrendForce.

The KOSPI opened 4.55% higher at 5,247.22 and touched 5,300.92 (+5.62%) before easing; buy-side sidecars were triggered on the KOSPI at 09:06 and the KOSDAQ at 09:10 KST. By 10:32 KST foreigners were net buyers for the first time in eight sessions, after selling an average ₩1.79 trillion a day over the previous seven (Yonhap); preliminary close data on Naver show a ₩353.2bn foreign net buy. Daishin's Lee Kyung-min said data-center permit delays "may slow the pace of investment execution, but will not directly lead to a decrease in the total volume" of AI spending (MoneyToday). On Wall Street, AMD rose 13.26% and Broadcom 8.78%; Nvidia closed at $178.67 after a low of $170.24.

The fundamentals news came from TrendForce. Analyst Hsu Chia-yuan expects 2027 server CPU shipments to rise at least 30% (base case 40–45%), against server DRAM bit supply growth of about 25%; even counting SOCAMM, supply grows only 35–40%. Total DRAM bit supply growth slows from 31% in 2026 to 24% in 2027 as node-migration gains fade, then recovers above 25% in 2028 as new fabs open.

Server DRAM plus HBM reaches 65% of DRAM supply by end-2027, squeezing other applications (China Times). Its weekly survey put DRAM lead times at 18 weeks (from 19), eSSD at 16 (balance 8) and ABF substrates at 48–56 (balance 12). US hyperscalers' server-DRAM demand is firm, while Chinese CSPs are trimming high-capacity RDIMM purchases (Digital Times).

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028. Unchanged overall. Supply evidence is a touch tighter (TrendForce's 2027 server-DRAM gap, EUV scarcity), while price momentum is a touch softer (DDR4 spot down again, lead times one week shorter). CYCLE SIGNAL: STOCKS REBOUND; SPOT STILL SOFT

CAPEX · LITHOGRAPHY

Samsung and SK Hynix Race for ASML EUV Tools

Samsung and SK hynix are each committing ₩10–20 trillion to ASML EUV scanners and may order earlier than planned because tool lead times have reportedly doubled, according to Solution News, cited by TrendForce. SK hynix has disclosed an EUV purchase of about ₩11.95 trillion, for delivery by Dec. 31, 2027, to move to 1c DRAM. Samsung is adding 1c lines for HBM4 at Pyeongtaek P4. It has ordered lithography tools for P5, whose first fab is targeted for 2028; equipment moves in after the first-phase cleanroom is finished in the first half of 2027. Both plan 1d DRAM in 2027 and limited sub-10nm "0a" output in 2028, with High-NA EUV on one or two layers. ASML said in October that its supply will fall short of demand in 2027 and 2028; memory was 46% of its Q3 system sales (TrendForce, Nov 10).

TAIWAN · MONTHLY DATA

TSMC and Taiwan Exports Set Records; Nanya's Monthly Gain Slows to 3%

TSMC's October revenue was NT$586.89 billion, up 14.7% from September and 59.7% from a year earlier (TSMC). Taiwan's October exports hit a record US$96.76 billion, up 58.9%, with integrated circuits up 63.0% to $31.17 billion (Ministry of Finance). Nanya Technology's October revenue was a 12th straight monthly record at NT$46.48 billion, up 487.7% year on year but only 3.07% from September (Anue). MediaTek's October sales were not out at press time.

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE NOV 9, 08:00 IST

NEW **Memory at 3× 2028 earnings.** Cantor calls the selloff a mid-cycle correction and says buy the dip. The SOX is 38% below its late-June peak and memory stocks 57%. On CY28 consensus EPS the SOX trades at 9× and memory at 3×. Top picks include Micron, Sandisk, WDC and Seagate. Cantor semis (Nov 9)

NEW **Near book value.** Goldman says memory stocks trade near 1.0× tangible book, with Samsung and SK hynix below total book; it sees Micron (Neutral) as more attractive on free cash flow. About 35 GW of 2027 US data-center additions look low-risk. Goldman Sachs Americas semis (Nov 9)

NEW **Tool orders say DRAM capex keeps rising.** Kokusai booked ~¥167bn of 2Q orders (+288% y/y) against an ¥80bn guide. It sees WFE of at least $140bn in 2026 (DRAM +40%, NAND +25%) and at least $190bn in 2027. Korean back-end tools are booked two to three years out. Onto's Advanced Nodes revenue was $135M, 60% of it memory. Jefferies Asia morning TMT (Nov 10); Jefferies, Cantor on Onto (Nov 9)

BEAR **Too early to bottom-fish.** Jefferies Europe warns DDR5 spot is at risk from data-center delays plus weak PCs and smartphones. A separate Jefferies note flags "Semi Tsunami follows Blue Tsunami": GPU oversupply could get worse. Jefferies (Nov 9)

ON X · SINCE MON ~08:00 · IST

@pequityresearch · Nov 10 03:55
Relays a Morgan Stanley note: memory risk-reward is “very favorable even with land/power/shell risks”; multiple compression offers “very compelling upside”; upturn cash goes to buybacks.
x.com/…/2119972131551297796

@SemiAnalysis_ · Nov 9 18:00
CXMT is talking up its $4F^2$ DRAM roadmap again; its first $4F^2$ DDR5 RDIMMs are targeted for sampling by year-end.
x.com/…/2119822428457030080

@antfeedapp · Nov 9 12:31
DRAMeXchange/Hana charts: 512Gb TLC spot fell from ~$23 to $16 and 1Tb TLC/QLC from ~$32 to $26, while DDR4/DDR5 spot stays elevated.
x.com/…/2119739555612180893

@jukan05 · Nov 10 05:35
A Taiwanese media report says Nvidia may cut TSMC orders, with AMD and ASIC makers taking freed capacity; he has “heard similar rumors.”
UNCONFIRMED
x.com/…/2119997381198721234

@SemiAnalysis_ · Nov 10 07:28
HBM5 doubles bandwidth on the same pins; the PHY can run at over 4× HBM4E power, so suppliers add a thermal “chimney.”
x.com/…/2120025703294894487

CYCLE TRACKER · SUPPLY A TOUCH TIGHTER; SPOT A TOUCH SOFTER

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 9 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new public contract print (October posted Oct 30). Nanya Oct revenue +3.07% m/m, a 12th record but slowing. Winbond: Q4 still rising, slower	**Rising, slower**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.17 (0.00%); DDR4 16Gb $79.99 (−0.31%), 8Gb $45.00 (−0.47%). NAND wafer $16.15 (−4.33% w/w) carry	**Softer**
Lead times / LTAs	TrendForce DRAM lead time 18 weeks (from 19; balance 8); eSSD 16 (balance 8). Chinese CSPs trim RDIMM buys; US firm	**Long, a week shorter**
Supply growth / capex	TrendForce: DRAM bits +24% in 2027 (from +31%); server DRAM ~+25% vs CPUs +40–45%. EUV race ₩10–20T each, P5 in 2028. CXMT $4F^2$ sampling by year-end	**Tight 2027; builds 2028+**
Valuation	Cantor: memory 3× CY28 EPS, −57% from peak. Goldman: ~1.0× tangible book; Samsung and SK hynix below book. Kokusai: 2026 DRAM WFE +40%	**Trough-like**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 34, NOV 9)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028. Unchanged overall. Supply evidence is a touch tighter: TrendForce sees 2027 DRAM bit growth slowing to 24%, with server DRAM short of CPU demand, and EUV tools are now a bottleneck for 2027–28 capacity. Price momentum is a touch softer: DDR4 spot fell for another session and DRAM lead times shortened by a week. The equity rebound (SOX +6.85%, Korea’s first foreign buying in eight sessions) is about positioning and valuation, not a change in the cycle.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 10–24 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Tue Nov 10	MediaTek Oct sales · Infineon Q4/FY (European morning) · US CPI 15:30 · Cohu investor day · SEMICON Europe · Cantor Convergence (Nov 10–12) · CoreWeave after the close	AI
Wed Nov 11	Korea Nov 1–10 exports · Veterans Day: US equities open, bond market closed	Korea
Thu Nov 12	Nebius before the open · Hon Hai results · Applied Materials, Cisco and SMIC after the close	WFE

Fri Nov 13	Advantest results · US PPI 15:30	Test
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3 (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 Nov 17–19	HBM
Wed Nov 18	House chairs' requested closed-door Huang briefing · Kulicke & Soffa (est.) and Soitec after the close	Policy
Thu Nov 19–20	Sandisk 8-for-1 split effective after Nov 19 close; split-adjusted Nov 20 · Anthropic IPO targeted (WSJ via Yonhap)	NAND
Mon Nov 23–24	HPE results · Jefferies EM conference, Dubai · Watch: TrendForce NAND weekly and month-end contract prices	Prices

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #35 · Nov 10, 2026